Plastic in the depths
A new research by scientists has revealed that the Earth's deepest point, the Mariana Trench, is polluted with microplastics. **https://dgit.in/jan19-19**

Saturn rings to disappear
Saturn's beautiful rings surrounding the planet may disappear in just a 100 million years. **https://dgit.in/jan19-20**

Perfecting online privacy through blockchain

The search for perfect online privacy is convoluted and blockchain-based privacy systems could be the solution

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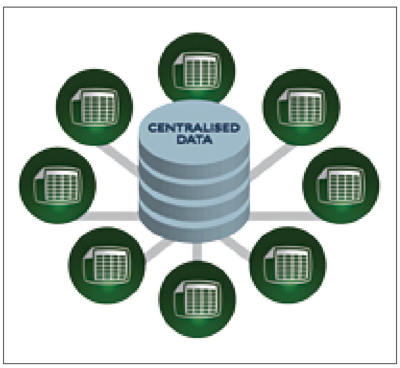
The inherent problem with public internet is the apparent disconnect between its architecture and our desire for privacy. High-profile hacks and data leak scandals constantly threaten user privacy, with examples of such scandals happening in companies like Facebook, Target, Equifax and more. The primary reason for this is that the data generated has slowly been centralised over time making them targets for nefarious activities and harvesting.

CENTRALISED DATA THREAT

The network of computers which is dubbed as the internet essentially operates as a large-scale copy and paste mechanism, which copies data from one computer and pastes it onto another while transferring data. The Facebook and Cambridge Analytica scandal that compromised personal information of over 87 million users to analytical firms shook the very core of the trust the users had placed on to the social media giant. It established the exact way companies harvest user data and later distribute it for monetisation purposes. Personal information and data are constantly being threatened due to centralised data storage.



Centralised data can leave users vulnerable to hackers and other agencies that harvest data without our knowledge.

When users share important information such as their name, date of birth, address, ID number and other sensitive data, it is passed on to third-party companies that want it. This causes two problems to arise. Users have to repeatedly fill the same information into forms every time they interact with a new site, and the second and more serious problem is that the firms then create copies and store our data in centralised databases that make them very vulnerable to hackers. The internet generates 2.5 quintillion bytes of data every day, with 90 per cent of the data generated in the last two years alone! This is where blockchain-based privacy systems could come into play and revolutionise the way our data is stored.